

**I. Processing List Procedures for Waiver Applicants**

Applicants who seek entrance into the waiver are screened for financial eligibility for the waiver. Applicants not deemed financially eligible are placed on a processing list until financial eligibility has been determined. The following procedures are to be used in the processing and maintenance of the Processing List for waiver applicants whose application is for Community Choices or HIV/AIDS Waivers. Procedures governing all other applications are set forth in the CLTC Policy and Procedure Manual. The Procedures herein will encompass activities beginning with referral/application processing and ending with waiver enrollment.

**II. Application Processing**

All Community Choices and HIV/AIDS waiver applicants are assigned to the Processing List once the referral is processed.

**Application Process:**

A. For all applicants with Category 80, 86, 16, 54, 17, 18, 19, 33, 10, or 15, CentralizedIntake releases the application to the Area Office. Phoenix will auto-assign the application to a Nurse Consultant overnight.

B. For all applicants with a Payment Category other than 80, 86, 16, 54, 17, 18, 19, 33, 10, or 15 the application is maintained in Centralized Intake until financial eligibility is determined by Medicaid Eligibility. If Eligibility Workflow states approved, the application is released to the Area Office. Phoenix will auto-assign the application to a Nurse Consultant overnight. If Eligibility Workflow states denied, the application is terminated by Centralized Intake. The Centralized Intake will notify the applicant and/or authorized representative of termination from the Processing List via CLTC Notification Form 171. The reason for termination, financial ineligibility, will be indicated in the comment section of the form. The ten (10) day notice and Appeals Notice are not required.

- C. For all applicants without current Medicaid eligibility, no payment category, the application is maintained in Centralized Intake until financial eligibility is determined by Medicaid Eligibility. If Eligibility Workflow states approved, the application is released to the Area Office. Phoenix will auto-assign the application to a Nurse Consultant overnight. If Eligibility Workflow states denied, the application is terminated by Centralized Intake. Centralized Intake will notify the applicant and/or authorized representative of termination from the Processing List via CLTC Notification Form 171. The reason for termination, financial ineligibility, will be indicated in the comment section of the form. The ten (10) day notice and the Appeals Notice are not required.

### III. Waiting List Requirements during Enrollment Cap

During times of budgetary constraints, restrictions in program enrollment or limitations on the number of persons that may be served by this program may be necessary. A waiting list will be maintained for applicants who have applied for enrollment. Applicants who are on the waiting list will be enrolled when a waiver slot becomes available, based on an assessment of medical need and urgency of waiver services. Applicants are issued a priority score based on that assessment. Applicants are prioritized on the waiting list by his/her priority score. In the event two or more are assessed to have the same priority score, the date and time of application will determine who is offered the next available waiver slot.

#### A. Waiting List Priority Levels

- Priority 1  
Incomplete assessment
- Priority 2  
Initial Phone or In-home assessment (complete or incomplete)  
Level of care is Medically Ineligible
- Priority 3  
Historical references – no longer used.
- Priority 5  
No assessment  
Medicaid eligibility is **NOT** verified

- Priority 7  
No assessment  
Medicaid eligibility **IS** verified
- Priority 8  
Assessment completed  
Level of Care is Skilled or Intermediate  
Medicaid Eligibility is **NOT** verified
- Priority 9  
Assessment completed  
Level of Care is Skilled or Intermediate  
Medicaid Eligibility **IS** verified
- Priority 10  
Initial phone or In-home assessment complete  
Level of Care is Skilled or Intermediate  
Medicaid Eligibility is **NOT** verified
- Priority 12  
Initial phone or In-home assessment complete  
Level of Care is Skilled or Intermediate  
Medicaid Eligibility **IS** verified  
Ready for enrollment

**B. Individuals Subject to Waiting List Requirements and Intake Criteria**

**1. Normal Intake Criteria**

Once application has been processed, it will be placed on the Waiting List until all intake criteria have been met.

2. Terminated Participant Re-applying

Any applicant who was previously terminated and is re-applying for waiver enrollment must be processed according to current Waiting List procedures. (Note: See Section III A. for exception)

3. Applicant on More Than One Waiver's Waiting List

An applicant may simultaneously be placed and remain on more than one waiver's Waiting List. The applicant must choose which waiver they wish to be enrolled in if they are awarded a waiver slot.

4. Other Applicant

Including those cited in 1, 2, 3 above, any applicant (other than an exempted applicant specified in Section III) will be subject to Waiting List requirements.

**C. Individuals Exempt from Waiting List Requirements**

1. Transfer from Mechanical Ventilator Waiver

A Mechanical Ventilator Waiver participant who becomes ineligible for the waiver due to discontinued need for the mechanical ventilator or desires to seek Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver may immediately be enrolled in the Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver if the individual meets the waiver's level of care criteria.

2. Transfer from HIV/AIDS Waiver

A HIV/AIDS waiver participant who becomes ineligible for the HIV/AIDS waiver or desires to seek Community Choices waiver may immediately be enrolled in the Community Choices waiver if the individual meets the nursing facility level of care and financial eligibility.

3. Transfer from Community Choices Waiver

A Community Choices waiver participant who becomes ineligible for the Community Choices waiver or desires to seek HIV/AIDS waiver may immediately be enrolled in the HIV/AIDS waiver if the individual meets the waiver level of care and financial eligibility.

4. Transfer from PACE

A PACE participant who becomes ineligible for the waiver due to discontinued need for PACE or desires to seek Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver may immediately be enrolled in the Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver if the individual meets the waiver level of care and financial eligibility.

**5. Transfer from Medically Complex Children**

A Medically Complex Children waiver participant who becomes ineligible for the MCC waiver or desires to seek Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver may immediately be enrolled in the Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver if the individual meets the waiver level of care and financial eligibility.

**6. Participant Temporarily Exiting the Program for Other Care (Full Calendar Month)**

An active Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver participant may enter any hospital, nursing facility, or medical institution for treatment, rehabilitation, non-waiver respite care or acute care. During the period of institutionalization, not to exceed on full calendar month, the participant's case may remain open to the waiver with restriction as set forth in the Community Choices Policy and Procedure section 05.40. The participant's waiver application must be closed no later than close of business on the last day of the full calendar month. Planned temporary stay subsequently, in accordance with Chapter 5 Section 05.40 of the Community Choices Policy and Procedure Manual, the individual may re-enroll in the waiver after both financial and level of care determination have been established.

**7. Organ Transplantation Participant**

Applicant or participant being considered for organ transplantation or having received an organ transplant whose eligibility and continued medical treatment are contingent upon waiver enrollment may be exempt from the Processing List dependent on the approval of the Central Office Designee.

**8. Previous Participant Financially Ineligible for Not More Than One Month**

A participant who loses financial eligibility for Medicaid for not more than one (1) month due to excess resources, lump sum payment and so forth, shall be exempt from processing list requirements when applying for re-enrollment in the program. The participant may be immediately re-entered into the program after both financial and medical eligibility have been re-established.

**9. Occupant of Nursing Home Bed for Ninety (90) or More Days and at Least the Last Day Under Medicaid Sponsorship**

A Medicaid sponsored individual who has resided in a South Carolina Medicaid contracted nursing home bed for ninety (90) or more days and at least the last day under Medicaid sponsorship, is not subject to the Processing List. If the individual is discharged to the community and chooses to receive waiver services, the individual

will immediately be entered into the program after medical eligibility has been re-determined, financial eligibility verified, and other waiver admission requirements fulfilled. For this to occur, CLTC must have been made aware of, and involved in, the plans for discharge to the community to ensure that appropriate community services can be provided to the individual without interruption. For MAO applicants, Medicaid eligibility is contingent on not more than a ten (10) day break in services.

**Note: For purposes of computing ninety (90) consecutive days, a combination of the listed institutions (defined as a South Carolina Medicaid contracted nursing home, swing bed, administrative day bed, or acute hospital bed) may be used; however, the applicant's vendor payment must be Medicaid upon discharge.**

10. Occupant of Swing Bed, Administrative Day, or Acute Hospital Bed

A Medicaid-sponsored individual who is seeking nursing home placement, no longer requires acute care, and no bed is available and is residing in a Swing Bed, Administrative Day, or Acute Hospital Bed is not subject to the Processing List. If the individual is discharged to the community and wishes to receive waiver services, the individual will be immediately enrolled in the waiver after medical eligibility has been re-determined, financial eligibility verified, and other waiver admission requirements fulfilled. For this to occur, CLTC must have been made aware of, and involved in, the plans for discharge to the community to ensure that appropriate community services can be provided to the applicant without interruption. For MAO participants, Medicaid eligibility is contingent on not more than a ten (10) day break in service.

11. Transfer from Children's Personal Care Service Program

A Children's Personal Care Service participant between the ages of 18 and 21 who requires other waiver services may immediately be enrolled into the Community Choices or HIV/AIDS waiver if the individual is medically and financially eligible without regards to the Processing List.

#### IV. Waiting List Maintenance

CLTC Centralized Intake will maintain the Waiting List accurately. Applications will be closed utilizing the correct termination reason when appropriate. This action is necessary to maintain both accuracy and consistency. It should be remembered that Waiting List data is utilized by various parties for planning and other statistics and purposes. Information received from Eligibility Workflow should be acted on promptly.

If a nursing home application is being processed for a waiver applicant on the processing list, the Nurse Consultant assigned to the nursing home application will determine if it is appropriate for the applicant to remain on the waiver Waiting List. If the nursing home

placement is expected to be long term or the applicant and/or authorized representative decline participation in the waiver, the Nurse Consultant will terminate the waiver application. If an applicant on the Waiting List is determined to be financially ineligible due to Eligibility Workflow being denied, a CLTC Notification Form 171 will be sent to the applicant to notify of the termination from the Processing List. A ten (10) day notice or an Appeal Notice is not required.